```
$text = <<<EOS
Highly irregular...
Highly irregular...
Highly irregular...
EOS;

var_dump(preg_match_all('/^Highly/', $text));
var_dump(preg_match_all('/^Highly/m', $text));

Output:
int(1)
int(3)
```

Our sample contains three lines of text, the line separations will be encoded either as *0x0A* (for Linux-based or similar systems), or as *0x0D 0x0A* (`CRLF` of Windows systems). The pattern `/^Highly/` contains the ^ metacharacter at the very start, this instructs the PCRE engine to anchor the pattern to the beginning of the sample (like the `A` modifier). Without a multiline modifier the pattern can only match once, at the very start of the sample, but it we add it via `/^Highly/m` then the pattern is applied at the beginning of sequence immediately after the *0x0A* byte (the beginning of each new line), which is why we have a count of `1` in the first `preg_match_all()` call, but `3` in the second. The reason why I've chosen to use the ^ metacharater to demonstrate this is because using the `A` modifier with `preg_match_all()` has the (undocumented) side effect of disabling global matching:

```
var_dump(preg_match_all('/Highly/Am', $text));

Output:
int(1)
```

Since we're in the neighborhood, here's how to anchor a pattern to the end of the sample by placing the $ metacharacter at the end of the pattern…

```
var_dump(preg_match_all('/\.\.\.$/', $text));
var_dump(preg_match_all('/\.\.\.$/m', $text));

Output:
int(1)
int(3)
```